

1.2.3 Moving around

Now let's get around to trying out Google SketchUp. The interface is actually incredibly easy to get used to and by the end of this section, you'll probably ponder the reason for the existence of this tutorial.

Panning: Go to the Getting Started toolbar, click on the pan tool (it's in the shape of a palm) and click on it. Click and drag anywhere on the workspace to move the workspace along. Using this tool, later on in the course of your modelling, you will be able to pan to different areas of your designs when they prove to be larger than your workspace in your preferred zoom. For getting better views, you may choose between the perspective, two point perspective and parallel projection options within the Camera sub-menu in the Menu bar. You may notice that the perspective view allows a slight angle of rotation to the camera (your view) so that it always stays focussed on the object, whereas the other two modes allow free translation of the camera. The Pan tool can be quickly accessed by pressing [H] on your keyboard, but the method you should use most often is to hold down [Shift], middle-click and drag.

Zooming: Click on the Zoom tool, once again from the Getting Started toolbar (it has a picture of a hand lens on it). Click on a point you wish to zoom to in the workspace and drag the mouse pointer upwards in order to zoom in. You can zoom out by clicking and dragging the mouse pointer downwards. You may more conveniently use the Scroll button on your mouse and scroll up and down (for zooming in and out, respectively). This can be done even when the zoom tool is not selected and hence is a quick way to zoom in and out while you are modelling. Alternatively, you may use [Z] on your keyboard for selecting the zoom tool. The Zoom Extents (hand lens with arrows around it) is a special tool that instantaneously gives you the largest view in which your whole model fits in the screen. Go ahead, click on the Zoom Extents tool and watch the man at the centre fill the screen.

Orbiting: Now that your knowledge of Google SketchUp has grown massive enough, you can start orbiting. Click on the Orbit button from the Getting Started toolbar (two crossed curved arrows), click